

Rehema Isa

Co.Founder Oya Solutions Group

Executive Leadership Development Practitioner, Communication and storytelling coach for professionals and organisations. TEDx Organiser (TEDxLytteltonWomen)
Lecturer. Programme Director. Keynote Speaker



Fluent in English, Swahilli with a working knowledge of French and understanding of Setswana

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Business executive with over 25 years of experience in strategy design and implementation and over 12 years in Executive Education. Expert in navigating business unusual, facilitating blue sky thinking experiences designing new realities and engaging teams on defining the next S curve. **Experienced programme manager** delivering business outcomes and nurturing high performance teams. **Expert facilitator** and coach asking the right questions. **Entrepreneur** - creating sustainable social enterprises promoting economic inclusion - evidencing its impact. **Master Storyteller and orchestrator** - working with individuals and organisations curating safe spaces for authentic storytelling, facilitating a greater connection between personal and organisation stories, developing inclusive and high performance team and work culture.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Director Oya Solutions (2018 to to Present)** - Co founder of a specialist strategy and leadership development firm, with a focus on executive leadership development, driving business performance, helping our clients think through and find better and more innovative ways to unlock growth.
- **Director Oya Foods (May 2020 to Present)** - Co-founder of an agrifood aggregator, supporting and growing a woman-owned and managed agribusiness value chain sustainably.
- **Co-Founder Womanomics Africa (May 2018 to Present)** - Co-founder of a Not for Profit advocacy connecting women to opportunities, ecosystems, and markets creating a Pan -African economic highway, driven by women, significantly and increasing women's participation in intra-Africa trade.
- **2022 - Date Curator and Educator** - The Leader's Voice Development and delivery of a Professional communication and storytelling masterclass delivered through Duke CE and Wits Business School (over 2000 attendees to date)
- **2023 - Orchestrator Women's Executive Leadership Programme** through Duke CE in collaboration with FASSET (250 participants)
- **2021 & 24 Curator and host facilitation** entrepreneur's guide to the AFCFTA series, a monthly masterclass on doing international and pan Africa trade.
- **2020 Digital Transformation Lead** launch of Womanomics Africa Virtual Campus - a digital metaverse with multi-stakeholder buy-in bridging the digital divide transacting on the organisation's digital transformation (over 5000 participants)
- **2019 Chief Convenor** Womanomics Africa Annual conference with a pan African outlook providing insights, visibility and capacity for entrepreneurs to leverage the AfCFTA, leading advocacy and thought leadership in this
- **2011-2012 Strategy and Enterprise Development Lead** Social Impact Initiative transforming the economic profile of a local community - Bushbuckridge Agro-Processing Hub
- **2012 Certified Women Entrepreneurship Development Expert** by the International Labour Organisation
- **2010-2011 Program Lead** ACSA ORTIA employee conversion programme converting employees to business owners taking over the airport's cleaning contract. (5 cleaning companies)
- **2009 - development** of a turnaround strategy for Bushbuckridge Water a water utility under distress
- **2005 - lead** of Consulting Team that developed a model for Eskom to evaluate Benefits Realisation of its historic investments in 5 of its critical technologies in the Distribution Network
- **2004 - owner** of Standard Bank Group Risk Heatmaps used as part of the entire bank's business continuity strategy
- **1994- 1998 Co-Founder** University of Botswana Small Business Clinic -

SOCIAL IMPACT

- **Ambassador** for South Africa - Women's Entrepreneurship Ideas and Content (ICEF) - Mozambique (2022)
- **Thought Leadership Contributor and on air personal development coach** bi-weekly on National Radio SAFM 2018 and 2019
- **TEDx Organiser** - Licensee and Head Speaker Coach TEDxLytteltonWomen (2015 to Present) profiling 100 African women on TEDx. Amplifying African Women Voices.
- **Convenor** UN Women Generation Equality Multi-stakeholder Forum Technology and Innovation Action Coalition Southern Africa (2021 to 2023)
- **Judge** : Swaziland BusinessWoman of the Year Awards (2014 - 2018)
- **Certified Advisor** African Aurora Business Network (Ghana) (2014 to present)
- **Executive Sounding Board** Imbeleko Foundation (2011 to 2020)
- **Member** of the Ministerial Committee of Women in Clean Energy, Education and Environment - Lead Economic Empowerment (2011-2014)
- **Chairperson** of Pretoria Branch and also **Board Member** Businesswomen's Association of South Africa (2009-2010)

AWARDS

- **Awardee Charlotte Manyane Maxeke** - Entrepreneurship (2024)
- **Entrepreneur of the Year** (Women of Stature 2022)
- **Overall Winner** Women of Stature 2022
- **Finalist** - Africa's Most Influential Women in Business and Government Media Sector - SADC South (CEO Global 2018/19)

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

- **University of Witwatersrand Business School**
 - Certificate in Leadership Development (2020)
- **University of Witwatersrand Business School**
 - Masters in Business Administration (2011)
- Association of Chartered Certified Accountants
 - Certificate in Accounting (1999)
- University of Botswana
 - Bachelor of Commerce (1998)

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Director Womanomics Africa (May 2018 to Present)

Co-founder of a Not for Profit advocacy connecting women to opportunities, ecosystems, and markets creating a Pan -African economic highway, driven by women, significantly and increasing women's participation in intra-Africa trade.

CEO Hadithi Media (Feb 2015 - Apr 2018)

Founder of an Independent strategy advisory and storytelling factory, publishing and distributing content by african authors. A specialist corporate storytelling firm - translating organisation strategy to film.

Managing Director Fuse Project Management and Consulting (May 2006 - Jan 2015)

Co-founder of an advisory and project management consultancy with key clients in water utilities, financial services and development organisations. A provider of capacity building technical support to entrepreneurs and business development service providers.

Principal Consultant - Eon Solutions (Mar 2005 - Apr 2006)

Executive in a consultancy in the engineering sector with a specialisation in the energy sector - a role of principal overseeing consulting leads

Manager Standard Bank (Aug 2002 - Feb 2005)

A manager in the risk function managing Business Continuity for the group (2003-2005) specialising in operational risk scenarios. A Management Information and Business Analyst role in Retail Credit (2002 -2003) optimising technology tools and data for Retail collections.

Financial Officer - Nedbank Technology and Operations (Jan 2001 -Aug 2002)

A manager in Financial Services Sector, responsible for financial Management and Reporting position for special projects and investments in Technology and Operations.

Audit Assistant - Deloitte (Jun 1998- Jul 1999)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Business executive with over 25 years of experience in strategy design and implementation. Expert in navigating business unusual, facilitating blue sky thinking experiences designing new realities and engaging teams on defining the next S curve. Experienced programme manager delivering business outcomes and nurturing high performance teams. Expert facilitator and coach asking the right questions. Entrepreneur - creating sustainable social enterprises promoting economic inclusion - evidencing its impact.

SKILLS & PROFICIENCIES

- Executive Leadership Development Practitioner and coach
- Strategy Design and Implementation
- Expert facilitator and program director
- Concept originator of sustainable programmes
- Strategic communicator and storytelling expert
- Stakeholder management and partnerships
- Expert in women's economic engagement and inclusion (*empowerment*)
- Early adopter of technologies and tools

SHORT COURSES

INTERNATIONAL LABOUR ORGANISATION CERTIFICATION

- Expert, Women Entrepreneurship Development for Gender Equality, 2010
- Trainer, Women Entrepreneurs Associations, 2010
- Trainer, Action My Business Growth, 2010
- Master Trainer, Expand Your Business, 2011
- Trainer, Women Entrepreneurship Development, 2012

INTERNATIONAL FINANCE CORPORATION CERTIFICATION

- Trainer, Business Edge, 2011
- Franchise Owner, IFC Business Edge™ Solution, 2011

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

University of Witwatersrand Business School
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University of Witwatersrand Business School
Masters in Business Administration (2011)

Association of Chartered Certified Accountants
Certificate in Accounting (1999)

University of Botswana
Bachelor of Commerce (1998)

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **2021 Curator and host facilitation sessions** of the entrepreneur's guide to the AfCFTA series, a monthly masterclass on doing international and pan Africa trade.
- **2020 Product Development Head** defining products taste and range including market appeal look and feel, pricing and promotion tactics.
- **2020 Digital Transformation Lead** launch of Womanomics Africa Virtual Campus - a digital metaverse with multi-stakeholder buy-in bridging the digital divide transacting on the organisation's digital transformation
- **2019 Chief Convenor** Womanomics Africa Annual conference with a pan African outlook providing insights, visibility and capacity for entrepreneurs to leverage the AfCFTA, leading advocacy and thought leadership in this
- **2015 - 2022 TEDx Organiser** Leveraging digital spaces to amplify African Women's voices as the Licensee TEDxLytteltonWomen (to date 85 Speakers showcased on the TEDx stage)
- **2012** Certified as a **Women Entrepreneurship Development Expert** by the International Labour Organisation
- **2011-2012 Strategy and Enterprise Development Lead** Social Impact Initiative transforming the economic profile of a local community - Bushbuckridge Agro-Processing Hub
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- **2004 - owner** of Standard Bank Group Risk Heatmaps used as part of the entire bank's business continuity strategy
- **2003 - accelerating implementation** of MIS Business Analysis tools into Retail credit at Standard Bank
- **1994- 1998 Co-Founder** University of Botswana Small Business Clinic - initiated while studying and now a formal university structure.

WORK EXPERIENCE

(May 2020 to Present)

Executive Director Oya Foods

- Executive responsible for business development, supply chain management, product development and operations management.
- Launched in lockdown, we developed unique vegetable based products to market with extensive testing. Currently increasing range of products and scaling up operations to service a growing market.
- Strategic partnerships - Oya Foods was invited as part of a presidential entourage during bilateral state visits to West Africa in 2021 showcasing South African Agri-businesses to do trade with in the AfCFTA.
- Effective 2023 Oya Foods is now part of a Gauteng Economic Development Incubator .

(Mar 2018 to Present)

Director Oya Solutions

- Orchestrator for Duke CE of FASSET IWFS Executive Development Programme for women developing over 1000 women in leadership acumen over 3 years
- Head of Leadership Development and Advisory Services, responsible for designing and implementing bespoke learning development experiences for clients such as Yale, Duke CE for their corporate clients like RMB, CitiBank, MTN, BMF
- Executive Education and Team Development coach and Action Learning Facilitator for clients Wits Business School and Jhb Business School. Designed BankSETA Leadership Integration Process for Wits Business School.
- Strategic planning consultant for growth oriented enterprises
- Facilitator and Programme curator for high impact initiatives

(May 2019 to Present)

Director Womanomics Africa (NPC)

- Concept originator, founder and Executive responsible for stakeholder management, investor relations, technology and programme office.
- Launched in 2019 and secured multi-stakeholder partnerships including an MOU with the dtic supporting AfCFTA initiatives for South African women driving business on the continent.
- Digital Transformation Lead - launched Womanomics Africa Virtual Campus which was commissioned as the home to UN Women Generation Equality Forum 2021 Activations - a world first!
- Design lead for the WA Trade Readiness programme in execution in 2023 in partnership with US Embassy and the department of trade industry and competition

(Feb 2015 to Apr 2018)

CEO Hadithi Media

- Executive Director of a storytelling factory and boutique management consultancy servicing clients on the African continent.
- Lead consultancy roles for the governments of:
 - Eswatini (office of the deputy prime minister) designed a strategy for greater inclusivity of Eswatini women participating in cross border trade and
 - Tanzania (ministry of works and transport) developed a strategy for development of a road safety agency and a strategy for national weighbridge management
- Providing board and executive team strategy interventions for clients like Transnet, South African Forestries, Financial Services board, Jhb Market, Oxfam
- Providing entrepreneur development support locally and on continent including (Botswana - Centre for Enterprises) (Ghana AABN)

SOCIAL IMPACT

- **Ambassador** for South Africa - Women's Entrepreneurship Ideas and Content (ICEF) - Mozambique (2022)
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AWARDS & ACCOLADES

- **Winner** Entrepreneur of the Year (Women of Stature 2022)
- **Winner** - Overall Winner Women of Stature 2022
- **Finalist** - Africa's Most Influential Women in Business and Government Media Sector - SADC South (CEO Global 2018/19)
- International Visitor's Leadership Programme - for Women Entrepreneurship **Scholarship awardee** (US State Department 2018)

WORK EXPERIENCE

(May 2006 to 2015)

Managing Director Fuse Project Management and Consulting

- Responsible for Strategic Stakeholder Management, Communication, and Business Development.
- Consulting Lead Designing and providing board and executive team strategy interventions for clients like Magalies Water, FNB Botswana, Eskom, Gauteng Department of Economic Development
- Programme Management Support for Eskom (technology), Hollard, FNB, Bushbuckridge Water and ACSA ORTIA
- Enterprise Development partner for the International Labour Organisation implementing Women Entrepreneurship Development for Gender Equality - providing master trainer capacity building for implementing organisations nationally.
- Secured an International Finance Corporation license for the flagship Business Edge programme with the premier execution in South Africa implemented with Avon-Justine and senior management in sales.
- Co-Founded Fuse IT and later disinvested in this enterprise.

(May 2005 to 2006)

Principal Consultant

- Led a team of consultants to deliver strategic projects in the engineering field in the energy sector.
- Development of Benefits Realisation Management Model for investment planning and review

Aug 2002 to Feb 2005

MIS Business Analyst and Business Continuity Manager - Group Risk

- Part of the team who designed, coordinated and executed on strategic simulations based on scenarios to manage business continuity for the bank both locally and globally for the standard bank group.
- Was the custodian of the strategic heatmaps indicating mission critical operations and responsible for ensuring these were continuously updated and communicated group wide to relevant stakeholders ensuring operations resilience against multiple scenarios.
- Coordinated management information requirements and technical specification mapping for retail credit collections at Standard Bank. Met objectives within a few months of appointment ahead of the 1 year anticipated turnaround time.

(Jan 2001 to Aug 2002)

Financial Officer in Technology and Operations

- Responsible for financial and administration management of Nedbank's investment in technology company Nihilent Technologies. Role included financial reporting on the investment and relationship management and ensuring that foreign on contract in RSA

(Jan 2001 to Aug 2002)

Audit Assistant

- First post degree employment as an audit clerk in training with clients including the mining Industry (Debswana), automotive sector and housing corporation

(Jun to Aug 1995-1997)

Contract employment during university holidays

- Contract employment at an audit firm, a motor vehicle company and the Botswana Centre for Human Rights as a bookkeeper.

E-SIGNED: *Rehema Isa*

DATE : 11 JUN 2024

NAME: Rehema Kate Isa